

When Did China Catch Up at Each AI Conference?

		UNITED STATES			CHINA			OVERTOOK ¹
		COVERAGE	FIRST	LATEST	CHANGE	FIRST	LATEST	CHANGE
ACML (ML)	2010–2024	4.55%	6.19%	+1.6 pp	12.1%	59.1%	+47.0 pp	2010
NeurIPS (ML / AI)	1989–2025	39.4%	30%	−9.4 pp	0.433%	38.9%	+38.4 pp	2025
ICML (ML)	2013–2025	48.1%	33.8%	−14.3 pp	4.53%	32.2%	+27.7 pp	Not yet
CVPR (Vision)	2013–2025	34%	16.1%	−17.8 pp	14.4%	39.2%	+24.9 pp	2019
ICCV (Vision)	2013–2023	32%	20.3%	−11.6 pp	15.7%	40.3%	+24.6 pp	2019
ICLR (ML)	2021–2025	49%	37.2%	−11.8 pp	8.7%	32%	+23.3 pp	Not yet
EMNLP (NLP)	2021–2024	37.5%	36.6%	−0.9 pp	2.73%	21%	+18.3 pp	Not yet
IJCAI (AI)	2020–2024	16.4%	12.7%	−3.6 pp	42.5%	57.6%	+15.1 pp	2020
CoRL (Robotics)	2021–2025	63.1%	53.2%	−9.9 pp	4.35%	19.4%	+15.0 pp	Not yet
RSS (Robotics)	2011–2025	47.6%	40.3%	−7.3 pp	0.806%	14.9%	+14.1 pp	Not yet
IROS (Robotics)	2000–2024	6.54%	11.7%	+5.1 pp	1.64%	15%	+13.4 pp	2006
COLING (NLP)	2020–2025	43.3%	21.2%	−22.0 pp	4.49%	16.5%	+12.0 pp	Not yet
ICRA (Robotics)	2000–2024	12.8%	16%	+3.2 pp	3.14%	14.3%	+11.1 pp	Not yet
UAI (Prob. ML)	2019–2024	39.8%	18.8%	−21.0 pp	3.06%	11%	+7.9 pp	Not yet
NAACL (NLP)	2021–2025	52.5%	35.3%	−17.3 pp	14%	20.2%	+6.1 pp	Not yet
ACL (NLP)	2021–2024	32.8%	25.4%	−7.4 pp	41.8%	46.6%	+4.8 pp	2021
AISTATS (Stats)	1995–2025	48.1%	39.9%	−8.2 pp	1.53%	6.24%	+4.7 pp	Not yet
COLT (Theory)	2011–2024	41.3%	61.2%	+19.8 pp	1.92%	3.29%	+1.4 pp	Not yet
SIGGRAPH Asia (Graphics)	2022	3.28%	3.28%	0.0 pp	14.8%	14.8%	0.0 pp	2022
WACV (Vision)	2020–2025	33.7%	26.1%	−7.6 pp	10.6%	10.2%	−0.5 pp	Not yet

Each row gives the U.S. and Chinese share of accepted author affiliations at the first and last year both countries are observed; that window is shown under Coverage and differs by venue. Change is the percentage-point change. "China overtook" is the first such year China's share exceeded the U.S. share; "Not yet" means the U.S. share still led in the latest observed year.

Data from Paper Copilot, conference acceptance and submission statistics; authors' compilation.
Chart by Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart, Stanford University.